
 Section: Our Dynamic Universe

 Topic: Motion, Equations and Graphs

Question 1 – A Van Braking at a Traffic Light

Given:

- Initial speed: $u = 13.4 \text{ m/s}$
 - Final speed: $v = 0 \text{ m/s}$
 - Acceleration: $a = -2.85 \text{ m/s}^2$
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(a) Calculate the distance travelled by the van during braking

✓ 3 marks

Use:

$$v^2 = u^2 + 2as$$

$$0 = (13.4)^2 + 2(-2.85)s$$

$$0 = 179.56 - 5.7s \quad \Rightarrow \quad s = \frac{179.56}{5.7} = 31.5 \text{ m}$$

✓ **Answer: 31.5 m**

(b) Calculate the time taken for the van to come to rest

✓ 2 marks

Use:

$$v = u + at \Rightarrow 0 = 13.4 + (-2.85)t$$

$$t = \frac{-13.4}{-2.85} = 4.70 \text{ s}$$

✓ **Answer: 4.70 s**

(c) Sketch velocity-time graph

✓ 2 marks

 On the graph:

- Vertical axis (v): from $v = 13.4 \text{ m/s}$ to 0
- Horizontal axis (t): from $t = 0$ to $t = 4.7 \text{ s}$
- Straight **sloping line down** from (0, 13.4) to (4.7, 0)

✓ **Must include:**

- Correct linear slope
 - Numerical labels on both axes
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 Revision Tips

- Choose equations with only known quantities
- Negative acceleration = **deceleration**
- A **v–t graph** with a sloped line = **uniform acceleration/deceleration**
- Area under v–t graph = **distance**